

Novolax

Bisacodyl

NAME OF THE MEDICINAL PRODUCT

Novolax 5 mg coated tablets

QUALITATIVE AND QUANTITATIVE COMPOSITION

Each coated tablet contains 5 mg bisacodyl.

Brownish yellow, biconvex, round, coated tablets.

CLINICAL PARTICULARS

Therapeutic indications

- *In acute constipation:* atonic, spastic, constipation due to haemorrhoids, changes of nutrition.
- *In Chronic constipation:* habitual, constipation in bed-ridden patients.
- For evacuation of the colon in preparation for the radiological examination or surgical operation of abdomen.

Posology and method of administration

Posology

Children aged 10 years or younger with chronic constipation should only be treated under the guidance of a physician. Bisacodyl should not be used in children younger than 4 years old.

Short-term treatment for constipation:

Adults and children over 10 years:

1 - 2 coated tablets (5 - 10 mg) daily before bedtime.

Children 4 - 10 years:

1 coated tablet (5 mg) daily before bedtime.

For preparation of diagnostic procedures and preoperatively

Should only be used under medical supervision.

Adults and children over 10 years:

2 coated tablets (10 mg) in the morning and 2 coated tablets (10 mg) in the evening and 1 suppository (10 mg) on the following morning is recommended.

Children 4-10 years of age:

1 coated tablet (5 mg) in the evening and 1 suppository (5 mg) on the following morning is recommended.

Method of administration

The tablets should be swallowed whole with some liquid (not milk). They should not be chewed or crushed as they might irritate the gastric mucous membrane.

During treatment with Novolax, sufficient amounts of liquid should be consumed. The tablets are best taken in the evening at bedtime, but they can also be taken in the morning. They produce a bowel movement within 8 to 12 hours if taken in the evening or within 6 hours if taken before breakfast. No dosage adjustment is required in the elderly and in patients with liver or kidney insufficiency.

Contraindications

Hypersensitivity to the active substance or to any of the excipients.
Acute abdomen (such as appendicitis), intestinal obstruction or gastrointestinal bleeding.

Special warnings and precautions for use

As with all laxatives, bisacodyl should not be taken on a continuous daily basis or for extended periods without investigating the cause of constipation.

Prolonged excessive use may lead to fluid and electrolyte imbalance and hypokalaemia.

Intestinal loss of fluids can promote dehydration. Symptoms may include thirst and oliguria. In patients suffering from fluid loss where dehydration may be harmful (e.g. renal insufficiency, elderly patients) bisacodyl should be discontinued and only restarted under medical supervision.

Stimulant laxatives including bisacodyl do not help with weight loss.

Patients may experience haematochezia (blood in stool) that is generally mild and self-limiting.

Dizziness and/or syncope have been reported in patients who have taken bisacodyl. The details available for these cases suggest that the events would be consistent with defecation syncope (or syncope attributable to straining at stool), or with a vasovagal response to abdominal pain related to the constipation, and not necessarily to the administration of bisacodyl itself.

Special information about some of the ingredients of Novolax

Novolax coated tablets contain lactose and sucrose. Patients with rare hereditary problems of fructose or galactose intolerance, the Lapp lactase deficiency, glucose-galactose malabsorption or sucrase-isomaltase insufficiency should not take this medicine.

Interaction with other medicinal products and other forms of interaction

The concomitant use of diuretics or adrenocorticosteroids may increase the risk of electrolyte imbalance if excessive doses of bisacodyl are taken.

Electrolyte imbalance may lead to increased sensitivity to cardiac glycosides.

The concomitant use of other laxatives may enhance the gastrointestinal side effects of bisacodyl.

Fertility, pregnancy and lactation

Pregnancy

There are no adequate and well-controlled studies in pregnant women. Long experience has shown no evidence of undesirable or damaging effects during pregnancy. Nevertheless, as with all drugs, bisacodyl should be taken during pregnancy only on medical advice.

Lactation

Neither the active moiety of bisacodyl BHMP (bis-(p-hydroxyphenyl)-pyridyl-2-methane) nor its glucuronides are excreted into the milk. Thus, bisacodyl can be used during breast-feeding.

Fertility

No studies on the effect on human fertility have been conducted.

Effects on ability to drive and use machines

Novolax is not known to affect the ability to drive and use machines.

Undesirable effects

The most commonly reported adverse reactions during treatment are abdominal pain and diarrhoea.

Immune system disorders

Anaphylactic reactions, angioedema, hypersensitivity.

Metabolism and nutrition disorders

Dehydration.

Nervous system disorders

Dizziness, syncope.

Dizziness and syncope occurring after taking bisacodyl appear to be consistent with a vasovagal response (e.g., to abdominal spasm, defecation).

Gastrointestinal disorders

Abdominal cramps, abdominal pain, diarrhoea, nausea, haematochezia (blood in stool), vomiting, abdominal discomfort, anorectal discomfort, colitis, including ischaemic colitis.

Overdose

Symptoms

If high doses are taken watery stools (diarrhoea), abdominal cramps and a clinically significant loss of fluid, potassium and other electrolytes can occur.

Bisacodyl, as with other laxatives, when taken in chronic overdose may cause chronic diarrhoea, abdominal pain, hypokalaemia, secondary hyperaldosteronism and renal calculi. Renal tubular damage, metabolic alkalosis and muscle weakness secondary to hypokalaemia have also been described in association with chronic laxative abuse.

Therapy

After ingestion of oral forms of bisacodyl, absorption can be minimised or prevented by inducing vomiting or gastric lavage. Replacement of fluids and correction of electrolyte imbalance may be required. This is especially important in the elderly and the young. Administration of antispasmodics may be of value.

PHARMACOLOGICAL PROPERTIES

Pharmacodynamic properties

Pharmacotherapeutic group: contact laxatives, ATC code: A06AB02.

Bisacodyl stimulates the peristalsis in the large intestine and increases the amount of water and electrolytes in the lumen of the small and large intestine. The patient has a bowel movement 6 to 12 hours of taking the tablets. When bisacodyl comes into contact with the mucous membrane of the large intestine, it stimulates the nerve endings and triggers a parasympathetic reflex, which increases the peristaltic contraction of the large intestine. It reduces the absorption of water, electrolytes and glucose in the small and large intestine, where it inhibits the action of the Na-K pump and increases prostaglandin levels in the intestinal mucous membrane and intestinal lumen.

Pharmacokinetic properties

Bisacodyl is rapidly converted to the active metabolite bis(p-hydroxyphenyl)pyridyl-2-methane in the body. After oral administration, it is poorly but variably absorbed in the small intestine. A small amount of absorbed bisacodyl is rapidly deacetylated in the liver to bisacodyl diphenol, which is conjugated with glucuronic acid.

Bisacodyl is mainly excreted in the faeces. Over 48 hours, approximately one quarter of an oral dose of bisacodyl is excreted in the urine as bisacodyl diphenol glucuronide.

PHARMACEUTICAL PARTICULARS

Special precautions for storage

Do not store above 30 °C.

Nature and contents of container

Blister pack: 105 coated tablets in a box.

PRODUCT REGISTRATION HOLDER

PAHANG PHARMACY SDN. BHD., Lot 5979, Jalan Teratai, 5 ½ Miles, Off Jalan Meru, 41050 Klang, Selangor, Malaysia

NAME AND ADDRESS OF THE MANUFACTURER

Manufactured for: KRKA, d.d., Novo mesto, Šmarješka cesta 6, 8501 Novo mesto, Slovenia

Manufactured by: Farmaceutsko-Hemijska Industrija (FHI) Zdravlje AD, Vlajkova 199, 16 000 Leskovac, Serbia

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10/2025